

The Alternative Informatics Association (Turkish: Alternatif Bilişim Derneği) is an Istanbul-based civil society organization focusing on the issues of media literacy, Internet censorship, and mass surveillance.

The association organizes conferences, workshops, publishes e-books, as well as contributes to the organization of online and offline campaigns against internet censorship, mass surveillance. Members have also contributed to publications and activities concerning digital literacy and online games.

Activities

Members of the association were part of the organization committee of Turkey's largest street protests against Internet censorship which took place in July 2010 in Istanbul and May 2011 with demonstrations in 30 cities.

In recent years the association has expanded its role in reporting breaches of digital rights in Turkey and demanding the protection of associated freedoms.

The Alternative Informatics Association organizes the annual New Media conference in Turkey which has brought together academics, activists and journalists to discuss threats against digital freedom.

History

Alternative Informatics Association gained its official status on December 31, 2010. However, the activities started online and offline before its inauguration.

2008

November 2008: ozgurinternet.info established

2009

June 7, 2009: Conference on the Internet Bans and Approaches to the Internet, Baro Apaydın Saloon/İstanbul

November 21, 2009: Panel Discussion on "Hate Speech on New Media", Tarık Z. Tunaya K.M./İstanbul

2010

March, 2010: Panel Discussion on "Hate Speech on New Media", Ankara University Communication Faculty Ankara

April, 2010: A Workshop for Discussing the Internet BEKSAV /Ankara

June-July 2010: The Declaration of the Common Platform against the Censorship, Taksim Protest March, Active participation in Turkish Grand Assembly Visits

July 1-4, 2010: Panel Discussion on Cultural Industries and Copy-Left European Social Forum, Istanbul

September 21-23, 2010: Participation in TBD (Informatics Association of Turkey) Informatics Convention/Ankara

September, 2010: Published book Hate Speech on the New Media- Collected Work, Kalkedon Publications

December 2-4, 2010: Participation in I-net, ITU (Istanbul Technical university)/Istanbul

December 31, 2010: Alternative Informatics Association gained its official status.

2011

January 29, 2011 "Panel Discussion on WikiLeaks", EMO (Chamber of Energy Engineers)/Istanbul

February 27, 2011 "Panel Discussion on Knowledge, Power, Internet Opposition", BİLMÖK (Congress of Computer Engineering Students), Yeditepe University

March 16, 2011 "Panel Discussion on the Internet Bans", Yıldız Technical University, Computer

Education Department, Istanbul

March 24, 2011, Panel Discussion on Hate Speech on the New Media, Anadolu University, Eskişehir

April 16, 2011, Workshop on Hate Speech on the New Media, International Hate Speeches Conference, Lütfi Kırdar/İstanbul

April 28, 2011, Day for Tracking Hate Speeches on the New Media, Turkey

May 6, 2011, Alternative Approach to ERP Processes, ERP Days Chamber of Architects and Engineers, ITU (İstanbul Technical University), Gümüşsuyu/İstanbul

May 10, 2011, Board for Information Technologies and Communication, Report against the Decision and Filter Application of the Board

May 15, 2011, March Against the Internet Censorship called "Don't Touch My Internet", Istanbul/Ankara

May 21, 2011 "Social Media" Computer Education Department Congress, YTÜ/İstanbul

May 25, 2011 "Participation in the Meeting of the Internet Board", Istanbul

June 3, 2011, Panel Discussion: Internet Censorship in Turkey Boğaziçi Univ., İstanbul

June 4, 2011, Workshop on Moral Values on the New Media, Kadir Has University, Department of New Media, İstanbul

Bring the case on the prevention of the website "sites.google.com" to European Court of Human Rights,

E-Book on Wikileaks and Arab Spring, titled Courageous New Media, April 2011

E-book, Politics Of E-Participation: Young People Online, ISBN 978-605-62169-1-6

September 12–13, UNICEF Workshop, Internet Usage of Youths and Children in Turkey, Ankara

September 16, Seminars on Dijital Video Games, METU Ankara

September 17, Internet Censorship, EMO Samsun,

September 17, Forbidding Forbidden round table meeting, ISEA, Istanbul

September 20, discussion P2P theory with Micahel Bauwens, Istanbul

October 14–15, Workshop on Mapping with FreeSoftwares, OpenStreetMap, Istanbul

October 16, Alternative Media Festival, Hate Speech, Digital Activism, Istanbul

November 10, case against the Decision and Filter Application of the Board, Ankara

November 18–20, LabourStart Int. Conference, Linux Workshop, Istanbul

December 1–3, sessions on INET'11, Censorship, Law and Internet, Internet Media and DPI, İZMİR

November 21–23, UNICEF Children Forum, Internet Usage of Youths and Children in Turkey, ANKARA

December 4 and January 21, Meetings on Internet as a Human Right on New Constitution, collaborated with Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung Turkei, ISTANBUL

December 27, session on Chaos Communication Congress 28C3, Berlin

2012

January 7, declaration, Academic Awareness and a Call to All University Rectorships Against The Deployment of ICTA's Filter

January 2012, Participating on establishing of Turkey Digital Game Association

February 18, Internet Blackout against SOPA

March 2012, Seminar Digital Surveillance, Marmara Univ.

March 2012, initiating of Istanbul HackerSpace, Istanbul

March 2012, Seminar "Suç altette mi?" on SOPA, PIPA, ACTA, etc., Bahçeşehir Univ., Istanbul

March 2012, Workshop: "The Future of Pardus" (Linux Distro by TUBITAK), İZMIT

March 2012, Workshop: Mind Map with VUE (visual understanding environment), Free Software Days Istanbul

April 9, Declaration of Internet Users' Rights

April 16, Statement about Internet in Turkey

May 20, Published Book: Digital Surveillance in Turkey: Digital Personification of Citizens in

Turkey from ID Numbers to E- IDs

June 16, Panel: "Digital Surveillance in Turkey"

October 23, Panel: "Surveillance, Censorship and Data Protection in Turkey", ECREA Pre-Conference

2014

September 2014, Internet Ungovernance Forum at Bilgi University

2015

July 2015: Digital rights activist Isik Mater voted in as president of the association

2019

February 2015 Lawyer Faruk Çayır voted in as president of the association

See also

Human rights in Turkey

== References ==